

Miles Mattson

QA Tester | Game Designer | Unity Developer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Recent graduate with a B.A. in Digital Narrative and Interactive Design (University of Pittsburgh, May 2026) and hands-on experience in game development, QA processes, and Agile workflows. Proficient in Unity (C#), Jira-based ticket tracking, bug documentation, and cross-disciplinary collaboration. Combines a developer's understanding of game systems with a designer's eye for player experience, well-positioned to identify, reproduce, and communicate defects at every stage of the pipeline. Practiced in AI-assisted development workflows, with a disciplined approach to validating, iterating on, and critically evaluating AI-generated output.

SKILLS

QA & Testing	Bug identification & reproduction, defect reporting, regression testing, playtest feedback analysis, build validation
Tools	Jira (ticket-based workflow), Figma / FigJam, Unity Editor, Git / GitHub Desktop, Chrome DevTools, AI-assisted development (LLM prompting, output validation, rapid iteration)
Programming Methodologies	C#, Java, HTML / CSS / JavaScript, C++ Agile / Scrum, scope management, playtest-driven feature prioritization, Jira ticket management
Design	Level design, encounter design, narrative/systems design, UI/UX review, design documentation
Soft Skills	Attention to detail, clear written communication, cross-team collaboration, rapid iteration, growth mindset

EXPERIENCE

Game Designer & Developer (Part-Time) | *Pixel Diamond Games* Aug 2023 – Present

- Worked within an Agile development pipeline using Jira for task tracking, naming all commits by Jira ticket number to maintain traceability across the codebase and keep the team aligned across sprints.
- Actively managed scope throughout the project by collaborating with the project lead to prioritize features, flag potential scope creep early, and make informed decisions about what to implement versus defer, keeping development on track and focused.
- Participated in iterative playtest cycles for Tombstone Taxi, observing player sessions, documenting gameplay issues and friction points, and working with the project lead to reprioritize the sprint backlog based on real user feedback.
- Designed and implemented a full two-phase boss fight from design document through minimum viable product, moving through the pipeline 60% faster by iterating to improve AI workflow.
- Implemented and debugged gameplay systems in Unity (C#), including collision, AI behavior, dialogue triggers, and audio, performing functional testing at each integration stage to catch issues early.
- Leveraged AI tools to accelerate development tasks such as scripting, documentation drafts, and design ideation, while applying a critical review process to validate correctness and catch errors before integration.

- Developed a dialogue system architected for forward compatibility, enabling future voice line and subtitle integration with minimal rework. Tested system behavior across multiple dialogue branches to ensure stability.
- Used Figma / FigJam to collaborate on UI/UX layout and encounter design, contributing to visual consistency and usability reviews.
- Produced design documentation including encounter specs, gameplay loop diagrams, and enemy archetypes to align team expectations before implementation began.

Capstone Project: The Narrator | [University of Pittsburgh](#)

Spring 2026

- Served as sole designer and developer of a first-person narrative Unity game set on a Martian colony, featuring branching dialogue, a multi-faction consequence system, four distinct endings, and a hidden secret ending.
- Managed the full project scope independently, setting milestones, adjusting priorities as development revealed new challenges, and keeping the core experience focused and shippable within the semester timeline.
- Conducted iterative self-testing and peer playtesting throughout development, identifying and resolving issues with dialogue state management, scene transitions, and UI clarity.
- Performed build validation for WebGL deployment, diagnosing and resolving platform-specific issues including compression format compatibility with GitHub Pages hosting.

Game Development Course | [iD Tech — Carnegie Mellon University](#)

July 2017

- Completed intensive program in Unreal Engine; greyboxed levels using free assets, collaborating with a team to integrate mechanics into a growing system.

EDUCATION

B.A. in Digital Narrative and Interactive Design | [University of Pittsburgh](#)

2021 – May 2026

- Major blending narrative design, game development, and programming — coursework in systems design, interactive storytelling, and game production workflows.
- Capstone: The Narrator — a complete Unity game demonstrating narrative systems, playtest iteration, and WebGL build/deployment.